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Campus Food Kiosk Menu App

1. Customer Discovery

Customer Profile

The primary customers are students at the European Universities in Egypt (EUE), including:

- **University of East London (UEL).**
- **University of Central Lancashire (UCLan).**
- **University of London.**

Secondary users include university staff, lecturers, and anyone who regularly spends time on campus.

Problem Statement

Students often have limited time between lectures and may struggle to decide where to eat. Since most campus food kiosks do not provide accessible menus, students have to visit each kiosk or ask staff about available meals and prices.

This can waste time and make it difficult to explore and compare food options.

Research and Observations

To understand the problem better, we spoke with staff members at three campus food kiosks:

1. **Batatas & Zalabia**
2. **Eat It Nao**
3. **Krispy Kreme**

During our conversations, we noticed that one of the cashiers had to list the entire menu from memory. We also saw a student nearby asking to look at the menu we had collected in our notes so she could decide what to order.

The staff members were also interested in the idea of having digital menus and supported the project. They helped us collect menu information, as none of the three kiosks currently provides an official physical or QR code menu.

Short Interview/Meeting Summary

Our conversations with the kiosk staff helped us understand that the problem affects both customers and employees.

The staff members were supportive of introducing digital menus, while our observation of students showed that having menu information readily available could make choosing food much easier.

2. App Proposal

Three Ideas Considered

Idea 1: Campus Food Kiosk Menu App (UniBites)

A mobile application that gathers the menus, prices, working hours, and contact information of the main food kiosks on campus.

Idea 2: University All-in-One Hub

An application that brings together Moodle links, Outlook, university announcements, and course materials in one place.

Idea 3: Historical Places in Egypt

An application that provides information about historical sites in Egypt, including ticket prices, opening hours, and locations.

Chosen Idea

We selected the Campus Food Kiosk Menu App (UniBites) as our final project.

Target Users

- University students.
- University staff.
- Lecturers.
- Other people who regularly spend time on campus.

Justification for Our Choice

We chose this idea for four main reasons:

1. It solves a real everyday problem

We have experienced the difficulty of finding out what food is available on campus ourselves. We also noticed other students facing the same issue during our research.

2. It is realistic for our current skill level

As foundation-year students, we wanted a project that we could realistically develop using our current Flutter knowledge while improving our programming and design skills.

3. The food kiosk staff were supportive

The positive responses from staff members made the project more practical. They were interested in having digital menus and helped us collect the necessary information.

4. It can be useful from the beginning

Even the first version, with basic menus and prices, could help students make quicker decisions without having to visit each kiosk first.

We decided against the other two ideas because the University All-in-One Hub would require connecting different university platforms and potentially accessing private information, making it more complicated to develop. The Historical Places application would have a much broader target audience and would not address an everyday problem within our university community.

3. Feature List

We divided the features into two categories: essential features for the first version of the application (MVP) and additional features that could be introduced in the future.

Must-Have Features (MVP)

These are the main features we aim to include in our initial version:

1. Search Bar

Allows users to search for specific meals, food items, or food kiosks across the application.

2. Food Kiosk Directory

Displays the three selected campus food kiosks:

- Batatas & Zalabia.
- Eat It Nao.
- Krispy Kreme.

3. Digital Menus

Provides each kiosk's complete menu, including available food items, sizes, and prices.

4. Working Hours

Displays the opening days and working hours of each kiosk.

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5. Simple User Interface

Provides a clear and easy-to-use design without requiring users to register or log in.

Future Features (Nice-to-Have)

If time and development progress allow, we would like to introduce:

- Coming Soon Section: Shows other campus restaurants that may be added in the future.
- Food Images: Includes pictures of available meals to help users explore their options.
- Price Comparison: Allows users to compare similar items across different kiosks.
- Pre-ordering: Gives users the option to place an order through the application before arriving at the kiosk.

Primary User Journey

The application is designed to make finding and choosing food as simple as possible.

1. Open the App: The student opens the application without needing to create an account or log in.
2. Browse or Search: The student searches for a meal or selects one of the available food kiosks.
3. View the Menu: The application displays the selected kiosk's menu, including food items, sizes, and prices.
4. Compare Options: The student explores different menus and compares prices.
5. Visit the Kiosk: After making a decision, the student visits the selected kiosk to place their order.